

Chapter 26-3

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Could this also be a test?

Liang Shi wasn't clear about it, but in any case, Xu Qingzhu had definitely noticed something.

Her attitude when talking to herself was much gentler than before. Liang Shi certainly didn't think it was because she had recently made changes and been a little nicer to Xu Qingzhu that she got this good attitude in return.

What a joke. If someone treated her like the original owner did, she would never forgive them for the rest of her life, and would even wish for that person to die as miserably as possible.

How could she forgive so easily?

There were only two possibilities.

One was that Xu Qingzhu deeply loved the original owner, and as long as the original owner showed even the slightest change, she would immediately have a change of heart and show a smiling face to the original owner.

But this possibility was extremely slim and could be passed over without hesitation.

Xu Qingzhu didn't seem like someone with a love-brain.

She might have had good feelings for the original owner at some point, but after being hurt, she would definitely wrap up her heart tightly and not let the original owner have another chance to hurt her.

So there was only the second possibility.

Xu Qingzhu had discovered that she wasn't the original Liang Shi, but also didn't know where she came from.

Science couldn't explain this abnormal phenomenon. As a top student, Xu Qingzhu was extremely cautious, so she constantly tested her in daily life.

After figuring this out, Liang Shi unexpectedly felt relieved.

After all, she didn't need to keep pretending in front of Xu Qingzhu. From now on, if she didn't remember something, she didn't remember; if she didn't know something, she didn't know. There was no need to be secretive about it.

Given Xu Qingzhu's caution, she wouldn't expose her without absolute certainty.

Liang Shi lay back down on the bed. She had been lying when she said she wasn't tired just now—she was actually dead tired. She hadn't slept well last night, and during the day she had gone to the Liang family home, leaving her physically and mentally exhausted.

It was just that with someone lying beside her, she couldn't fall asleep.

Now that there was only her left on the bed, although Xu Qingzhu's scent still lingered in the air, it didn't affect her much.

Before sleeping, she remembered to set an alarm and quickly fell asleep.

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Xu Qingzhu curled up on the downstairs sofa reading a novel.

Having slept for a day and night, she wasn't particularly tired.

But her body was weak. After reading for less than two hours, her eyes became dry and sore, and she couldn't concentrate on reading anymore.

She had to close the book and rub her eyes downstairs. Guessing that Liang Shi had already fallen asleep, she unhurriedly went upstairs.

She opened the door very gently, afraid of waking the sleeping person.

A lamp was on in the room, just illuminating the doorway.

When she left, she had clearly turned on the lamp on Liang Shi's side, near the balcony, but when she returned, the lamp on her side was on, perfectly lighting her path back to bed.

Liang Shi's sleeping posture was very proper. She lay flat with her hands resting on her abdomen, breathing lightly.

Xu Qingzhu walked over and sat on the bed, causing one side of the bed to sink slightly.

Liang Shi didn't stir, seemingly fast asleep.

Xu Qingzhu put the book in the drawer, then slowly moved onto the bed, leaning against it and looking sideways at her.

Liang Shi recently hadn't been wearing makeup, or rather, she wore light makeup.

The previous Liang Shi would always wear makeup no matter how late she came home, and it was heavy makeup.

She liked all sorts of inappropriate colors, especially lipstick—she was basically a clearance handler for unsold colors, just relying on her good looks to mess around.

Several times, Xu Qingzhu had seen her sleeping on the sofa with makeup on.

But the current Liang Shi, although she had the same face as before, her eyes were completely different.

Some people say that to judge a person's character, you should look at whether their eyes are bright.

If her eyes are bright as stars, then she must be a person of upright character.

The previous Liang Shi's eyes had no luster, only deep hatred for this world, and sometimes, she would even show that expression of wishing everyone would die.

But the current Liang Shi's eyes always radiated a gentle luster.

Xu Qingzhu was someone good at observing details, just like how the current Liang Shi would hide all her behaviors in the details.

Except for that time in the hospital when she rashly carried strawberries into the ward and brazenly said she would change, hoping that she could trust her, all other times she was calm and gentle.

She always seemed to emit a faint scent of white tea¹.

Very reassuring.

During the time when grandfather passed away, Xu Qingzhu's room would always have a pot of white tea brewing.

She habitually fell asleep smelling that scent, as if grandfather had never left.

She smelled that reassuring scent again.

But she really couldn't confirm who Liang Shi really was.

Where did she come from?

She sat there, her gaze tracing over the other person's features inch by inch.

She still thought she looked better without makeup.

But... what did it have to do with her?

In any case, she was going to divorce Liang Shi.

She didn't want to follow her father's words and use marriage as a bargaining chip to exchange for the company's survival, nor did she want grandfather's life's work to come to nothing.

She had to enter the company, even if father opposed it.

Speaking of which, the last time she sent a message to father, his reply was only two words: "Not allowed."

Father felt that if she married into a good family, married an Alpha who was good to her, that would be the best thing for her life.

But he forgot that she had been first place since childhood, entered Qingyi University² with high scores, and even obtained an MBA degree.

If she hadn't been unwilling to go too far from home back then, she should have gone abroad for further study.

It was also for the company, and for a little bit of her own selfishness, that she chose marriage.

But what had this marriage brought him?

Only endless pain and constant fear.

Xu Qingzhu sighed lightly. In the middle of the night, she always couldn't help thinking about these things, worrying about them.

She decided not to listen to father's decisions anymore, and sent a message to her uncle who also worked at the company, saying that she planned to go to work at the company and needed him to arrange a position for her. There was no need to parachute in and squeeze out existing employees—she just needed an opportunity that would let her work at the company, preferably in the company's core departments, either the design department or exhibition department.

For a jewelry company, the design department was the core. Without excellent designs that could surpass competitors, it would never be able to establish itself in the industry.

The exhibition department was responsible for shows when new products were released each year, from hiring models to defining each piece of jewelry, indirectly affecting the sales of every new product.

Equally important were the advertising department and marketing department.

Every marketing plan determined whether jewelry could be seen by the public at first glance and arouse consumers' love. The era of "good wine needs no bush"³ had passed. In today's era, marketing was an indispensable link.

Xu Qingzhu's major should be most suitable for the human resources management department, but she still decided to go to a more essential place.

If she wanted to completely reverse Minghui's current situation, she would inevitably have to pull out the rotten roots directly. Bringing in new people would be meaningless—it would just be grafting new shoots onto rotten roots, which would rot sooner or later.

Uncle quickly replied, telling her to come anytime. The design department happened to have a management-level vacancy, and she could take it directly when she came.

Parachuting in seemed to be the fastest way nowadays.

Xu Qingzhu replied to him: [Okay, thank you, uncle.]

After a few seconds, she replied again: [I'll report for duty tomorrow.]

¹ 白茶 (**báichá**) - White tea, a delicate type of Chinese tea known for its subtle, calming fragrance

² 青翼大學 (**Qīngyì University**) - A fictional prestigious university in this story

³ 酒香不怕巷子深 - Chinese idiom literally meaning "good wine needs no bush" or "the fragrance of wine is not afraid of deep alleys," referring to the idea that quality products will naturally attract customers without heavy marketing